

Some toadstools grow in circles, known as “fairy rings”. People used to believe they showed where fairies and elves danced.



Toadstool

The red-and-white pattern of this toadstool is a warning — it contains deadly poison! Toadstools aren't all dangerous, but many are, so you should never pick and eat them. Toadstools are not plants or animals. They belong to a group called fungi (fun-gee). Mushrooms and moulds are fungi, too.

Fungi mainly live out of sight — what we see is just the “fruit” part. Underground they grow millions of threads, similar to roots. These feed on dead and rotting things. Yuck! It sounds disgusting, but by doing it, fungi rescue food from the soil. This is such an important job that most life on our planet could not exist without fungi.

